

Area of Study 2: Popular Song: Blues, Jazz, Swing and Big Band

Outline	Learners should study in depth the development of song and the singers in early popular and recorded genres: • use attentive listening and contextual knowledge to analyse, evaluate and make critical judgements about the repertoire • use technical vocabulary to communicate a sophisticated understanding of music and its context. This includes but is not limited to: • Vocal Jazz and Blues • popular solo song • recordings by vocal artists of repertoire • interpretation of 'standards'. A prescribed work from this Area of Study will be part of the focus for study although learners should understand about the context and development of the music around the prescribed work.
Focus for learning	Learners should analyse, explain and compare developments in styles of jazz, including: • song structures • performing techniques e.g. improvisation. Learners should study and understand how artists use musical elements, including: • delivery and expression of lyrics • application and treatment of the melody and lyrics • vocal techniques e.g. belt, use of register, articulation, vibrato • dynamics and expressive techniques and devices • use of accompaniment • relationship of voice and accompaniment • organisation of pitch, melodically and harmonically • musical vocabulary and terminology related to the Area of Study. Learners should study and understand the conditions and context in which jazz music was created and performed, including: • the effect of audience, time and place on how the songs are created, developed, performed and recorded including developments in recording and technology • the historical and social context of the songs in this Area of Study • working conditions for musicians.
Prescribed works	See appendix 5d.
Suggested repertoire	There is no suggested repertoire for this Area of Study.